Cyber Security Capstone Final Assignment

Self-Reflection Business Letter

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KSU Graduate

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Hiring Manager
Cox Enterprises

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am a recent Kennesaw State University graduate with a BBA in Information Security and Assurance. My education at KSU has equipped me with relevant skills and knowledge in Cybersecurity, enabling me to apply for roles that interest me, such as application security and security analyst. Both respective roles hold an interest to me as they require the foundation of Cybersecurity, the CIA triad, which requires the key concepts of confidentiality, integrity, and availability. These three factors are the pillars that support the ideals of protecting sensitive information, whether that crucial data is being processed, stored, or transmitted, and are vital requirements in the age of big data: that it remain confidential for the security of the user and the integrity of the corporation.

My time as a student at KSU has prepared me both professionally and technically for the stated roles, specifically, in the Cyber Defense Capstone. The course required students to challenge themselves to work in a group environment as they developed skills relevant to cybersecurity professionals, including mastery of InfoSec theory and practice, ensuring we were prepared for our professional roles after graduation. For example, throughout the semester, I was a part of Group 7, where we organized ourselves into roles relevant to a functioning CSIRT team. I took on the role of Incident Response Manager, providing leadership and direction throughout the Incident Response process. The project at hand was to develop an IR policy and procedure. Through a communication plan I built, I dubbed the Master Document, I supplied my team with all important dates and relevant information. It served as a focal point for our organization, allowing us to set clear expectations and communicate effectively and ethically.

Through these practices, my group developed a 30+ page Incident Response Plan comprising playbooks, communication templates, severity classifications, and a chain of command. The plan served as a reference point for when an incident response is to occur; it outlined a plan of action to appropriately and effectively respond to incidents, ensuring business continuity, based on the case study and a policy document for a fictitious corporation called Cyber Tree Systems. As one of the final projects in the Cyber Defense course the IR Plan was tested in a Tabletop Exercise (TTX) led by our professor, in which a simulated incident was presented to us in where we had to act in our respective

roles and use only the plan that we had created to stress test the information we had used, after the TTX, my group conducted a hotwash where we discussed issues we think needed to be addressed, and what we had done right. We compiled all the issues we had analyzed and designed more secure solutions to ensure our IR plan was well-aligned and more effective for the following incident response.

Overall, the collaboration and efforts of my group gave me a well-rounded experience that allowed me to go through the motions of risk management and the professional-level processing and planning, while upholding relevant response leadership to ensure an authentic experience. It was not a simple task, but it was undoubtedly one of the most rewarding things I have done during my time at KSU, preparing me not only for the professional world of Cybersecurity but also for relevant talking points in entry-level interviews and for a well-rounded project to add to my portfolio.

I am confident that I have fully grasped the professional readiness expected of me, enabling me to communicate not just effectively and respectfully with my team, but also with those outside the project. Such as discussing with peers as a form of networking. Planning, building, and operating security information infrastructures, including firsthand experience with a SIEM tool supplied by WitFoo and, through that experience of observing aggregate security logs and understanding how to dissect the given dashboard and interpret that information to then communicate that to the relevant manager, it allowed me to obtaining the Precinct Certification through the course. The overall learned was tied to the Cyber Tree Systems policy and case study which allowed me to identify risks built in the procedure and gave me the ability to make decisions of what tools to add, such as integration of SIEM tool to tie together firewall and VPN security to create a more secure environment, all while preparing appropriate levels communication, both presentations and in the composition of communication to convey secure solutions that would help maintain business continuity.

Through Kennesaw State University, I have developed a well-rounded education that has enabled me to present relevant projects and knowledge to the professional world of Cybersecurity, making me a better-suited candidate in the technology industry. In both professional standards for effective communication and leadership, and in technology, I have developed relevant projects, in both in academic setting and personal, that have enabled me to pursue opportunities outside KSU and have given me an educational advantage, with a commitment to continuous growth and contribution in the field of Cybersecurity.

Thank you for your time, Hiring Manager. I am looking forward to the opportunity to demonstrate my knowledge of information security and to develop it further within the corporation.

Best regards,

Sam Miller

LLM and Artificial Intelligence Tool Usage Statement:

Answer Yes/No	In preparing for this assignment, I used assistance for the checked items	Prompt Used/Comments
No	Planning/Outlining: I used external LLM/AI assistance to plan or outline the topic.	NA
No	Research: I used external LLM/AI assistance to perform preliminary research.	NA
No	Composition of Text: I used external LLM/AI assistance to compose any submitted text.	NA
No	Creation of Graphics or Videos: I used external LLM/AI assistance to create graphics or videos included in the submission.	NA
No	Conceptual or Critical Review: I used external LLM/AI assistance to perform a conceptual or critical review of the draft work.	NA
Yes	Spell Checking and Grammar Review: I used external LLM/AI assistance to perform spell checking or grammar review.	Grammarly
No	Assistance from Other People: I received assistance from another person.	NA
No	Reuse of Previous Work: I reused by copying or repurposing work submitted for this or another course. If any use is included, how was it used, and did you seek permission from the instructor in advance?	NA
Yes	Certification: I affirm that all statements above are accurate and that the submitted work complies with the course's academic integrity policies.	